



HTC One M8

HTC One M8 announced, will be available for sale in India this month
<http://dgit.in/HTCWanM8>



Who was Carl Sagan really?

A profile piece on this famed scientist and celebrity. What was his life like? Find out at
<http://dgit.in/carlsag>

Feature

The drop in capacity, cylinders and a lower rev limit has dropped power from a hair-chested 750 bhp to a lean and muscular 600 bhp has made the cars a tiny bit slower. However, the teams seem to be 'managing' as the season progresses.

Fun Fact: Formula 1 is bringing back the turbo for the first time since 1988.

The turbo noise

People ask, "Why have a separate caption for the noise created by the new cars?" Well, like many eccentric fans, one believes that the raw noise emanating from the engine is a part of the F1 essence. The cars now, however, have a different sound as

the exhaust gases while the other takes power from the rear wheels while braking. The former is also used to keep the turbo spinning so that power is always available on tap. The ERS stores more energy than its earlier counterpart. All in all, this essentially means that not only is there more power, but more torque as well for a longer period of time.

It's interesting to note how F1 is moving towards the hybrid engine era. The sport joins the league of Le Mans which also uses hybrid engines, but Le Mans is more of an endurance race than a festival of speed.



Low downforce? Will it fly now?

The new DRS flaps are flatter and open wider thus reducing drag and allowing easier overtaking.

So what does all this mean?

Considering that the sport was being blamed for being too dependent on technology and repetitive not so long ago, the new measures ensure that every team, no matter how good, starts from scratch. The purpose of all this fiddling seems to be to level the playing field and bring focus back to the core of F1, i.e., the driver.

While all of this has been done for the benefit of the sport, the regulations have no doubt produced a slower, heavier car. The minimum weight of the cars has been increased from 642 kgs to 691 kgs to incorporate the weight of the hybrid power unit. There was also a definite 3-second lag in the fastest lap this year in



Rhinoplasty reminiscent of Rhinos

the high pitched whine of the naturally aspirated V8 has been replaced by the quieter but zippier sound of the turbocharged V6. Good news for all the Delhi socialites who developed severe headaches last year after the Indian Grand Prix!

The shift in engines did, however, ignite a fear among die hard fans that the sport would lose its voice due to the more tamed sound of the turbo; however, the race in Melbourne erased all such doubts as the new cars raged through the tracks.

To ERS is F1

The 2014 model is also harvesting power from the shiny new Energy Recovery System (ERS) which has been incorporated as a part of the power unit. The ERS provides at least 160 bhp per 33 seconds as compared to the 80 bhp per 6 seconds provided by the earlier Kinetic Energy Recovery System (KERS).

The ERS essentially has two supporting units. One draws energy from

The nose job

One major change in the aerodynamics this season is that of the nose of the car. It has been lowered from a height of 550mm to 185mm. However suggestive the new look may be, it steps up driver safety as there is now a lower chances of the car doing belly flops on the race track after getting hit.

Clipped wings

The car now looks sleeker with its front wings narrower than the rest of the body. The wings have been chopped from a width of 1800mm to 1650mm. This prevents drivers from clipping each other's wings. The changes to the front wings have also reduced downforce by a good 20 per cent, making the race car a bit of a loose cannon as it becomes harder for it to stay in line.

Rear wing

The rear wing has also gone under the knife as the lower beam has been removed and the Drag Reduction System now opens wider. If that made no sense to you then let us explain.

The Drag Reduction System or DRS is essentially an adjustable rear wing. The function of the DRS is to allow a free flow of air, reducing drag, which when engaged in specific zones on the track allows the driver to simply go faster.



Flying high

the Melbourne Grand Prix as compared to 12 months ago.

But the season has barely started and there are plenty of races to follow, as avid fans, we're just happy that the element of unpredictability is, at long last, back in this prestigious sport. **[1]**